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HEADQUARTERS
COUNTER INTELLIGENCE CORPS REGION IV
970TH COUNTER INTELLIGENCE CORPS DETACHMENT
APO 407-A, US ARMY

IV-2574

1 March 1948

MEMORANDUM FOR THE OFFICER IN CHARGE:

SUBJECT: ZIEGLER, Walter Krich

1. Reference is made to letter, Hq 970th CIC Det., EUCOM, file D-198239, Subj: Flying Saucers, dated 28 October 1947, furnishing KRI's for the questioning of aircraft specialists.

2. The following information was obtained in the course of interrogating Subject:

a. Personal Data

Name:
Aliases:
Date and Place of Birth:

Walter Krich ZIEGLER
None

Residence:

Formerly BERLIN, since 1944 HAD
AIBLING (M48/Z12), at present

Education:

"Oberrealschule" at METZ, Lorraine,
studied engineering at ILMENAU/
Thuringia where he completed the
examinations as "Maschinen-
Ingenieur" in 1929

Marital Status:

Married to Leni ZIEGLER, nee WEISS,
one son Walter, sixteen (16)
years of age, who is still going
to school.

Religion:
Profession:

Protestant
Aircraft engineer, specialized in
rockets.

Occupation:

Employments since 1929 -- first
with the Firm "Siemens & Halske",
BERLIN; then "Deutsche Ver-
suchsanstalt fuer Luftfahrt",
BERLIN; again "Flugmotorenbau
Siemens", BERLIN; and finally
director at "BMW" (Bayerische
Motoren-Werke), Section Rockets,
first in BERLIN, and since 1943
at BRUCKMUEHL, Landkreis AIBLING,
as leader of the BMW plant lo-
cated there. At present Subject
is the director and owner of a
small metal firm at BRUCKMUEHL,
seventy-two (72) employees, which

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Copy to op. 12 March 1948
Krich

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Army Record:

Nazi Record:

- Criminal Record:

produces cooking pots, etc., said firm being founded in October 1945.

None. UK during the war due to his scientific work on rockets. Membership in DAF and NSV without positions; according to his Spruchkammer sentence Subject does not come under the denazification categories. No previous convictions.

b. During the course of the interview, it was revealed that Subject had never met the HORTEN brothers personally, but that he had heard that they were working on some special type of plane which never appeared in mass production. Furthermore, Subject stated that he has heard that the Russians are at present producing the HORTEN plane; however, he does not know where the plants are located. Subject further stated that he has no knowledge concerning the present whereabouts of the HORTEN family, but that he believes some of his acquaintances among his former colleagues may be able to furnish some information concerning the HORTEN's and their work. He promised to be as helpful as possible in an unofficial manner, and pass on any information he might obtain to the undersigned. According to Subject, the following persons may know something concerning the HORTEN family:

(1) Director BAUER, formerly of the MESSERSCHMIDT Werke, at present residing at OBERAMMERGAU (exact address of Director BAUER can be obtained through his brother, the owner of "Gerberei BAUER" at ROSENHEIM (M48/Z22), whom Director BAUER visits frequently). Otherwise Subject has the address of Director BAUER on file at his office in the firm at BRUCKMUEHL, where he can be reached at telefon BRUCKMUEHL 102.

(2) Professor MESSERSCHMIDT of the MESSERSCHMIDT Werke, at present being held at NURNBERG (M50/040), and whom Subject describes as an honest and upright character whose main interest in life is his technical and scientific research, and who has an excellent knowledge of persons of importance in aeronautics, most of whom he knows personally.

(3) Director BIEFANG, at present residing at VENNICKEL near MUEES, district KREFELD (BZ), formerly a director of BMW, Motor Building Section. BIEFANG is a personal friend of Subject, with whom he is in constant contact and whom he will visit in a short time.

(4) Inu SPOROWSKI, presently residing in LAUFEN, one of the first men in the former German rocket building industry, who is at present being tried before the LAUFEN Spruchkammer. Subject believes that this man may also be able to give some information concerning the HORTEN plans, but he is personally not on speaking terms with him due to the fact that he (Subject) has to appear before the LAUFEN Spruchkammer as a witness against SPOROWSKI, the latter having been a personal friend of HDMLER and also of KALTENBRUNNER, who is a godfather to one of SPOROWSKI's children.

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(5) Professor Peter WAGNER, formerly of KOCHER, at present believed to be in the United States. He was in charge of the construction of the "Zellen" (bodies) of rocket planes.

(6) Ernst VOGT, formerly of KOCHER, present address unknown to Subject. He was formerly a department leader of MESSERSCHMIDT who supervised the installing of motors in the type ME 262 (?) planes. VOGT also built the special plane "Josephine", which was a special construction and designed for action in Japan, radius 1.200 km.

As previously mentioned, the above listed persons are acquaintances of Subject. However, Subject believes that besides having some knowledge concerning the HORTEN family, they may also give him the names of other people in this area who might have any pertinent information.

c. During the course of the interview, Subject also spoke of the following:

The three (3) main departments or sections of the "Bayerische Motoren Werke" were: (1) Plane engines or motors; (2) turbines; and (3) rockets. Subject worked in the latter section. One of the main tasks of this section, besides the actual developments of rockets, was the building of the plane type "ME 163 Raketen-Jaeger" (a fast rocket fighter) in collaboration with the MESSERSCHMIDT Werke. This plane had a speed of 1.400 km per hour in 1944.

d. A small sector BMW Rocket Plant (400 men), who were still employed in BERLIN at the end of the war and were then with all remaining machinery transplanted to HALLE, continued their work there for the Russians. In September 1946, these men were called up at two o'clock at night by the Russians and were transported to KUBISCHEW, which is a small town of approximately 15,000 inhabitants east of MOSCOW, where they are presently constructing rockets under Russian supervision. Some of these men were permitted to take their wives. Subject also heard of a small jet-propelled plant of the MESSERSCHMIDT Werke, which was transported together with the remaining personnel to the Caucasus, and who are allegedly continuing to construct jet-propellers.

e. When questioned in reference to contacts with foreign powers other than the Americans, Subject stated that a representative of the British War Ministry, one Sir FATTEN, payed him a visit at BRUCKMUEHL some time in May or June 1945. This man was most interested in the German phase of the developments of rockets, and took some samples with him. Late in 1945 or early 1946, Subject was approached by some Germans who represented the Russian government and who also came to see him at BRUCKMUEHL offering him various good contracts if he would be willing to work in Russia. He refused these offers. In 1946, Subject was granted the permission by the American authorities to be interviewed by some French experts on the developments of rocket. Subject went to LINDAU/Bodensee (FZ) to meet the directors of the

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French Work "Artistic Aeronautic", at that time at LINDAU and at present located in the south of France, and with which firm a greater number of former colleagues of Subject are now being employed.

3. Agent's Comments: Investigation closed.

SOURCE: Walter Erich ZIEGLER

EVALUATION: F-6

APPROVED:

Camille S. Hajdu
CAMILLE S. HAJDU
Special Agent, CIC

Rudolph J. Geiser
RUDOLPH J. GEISER
Special Agent, CIC

List of Personalities, Places and Impersonal Subjects ✓

Walter Erich ZIEGLER
HORTEN family
Director BAUER
MESSERSCHMIDT Werke
OBERAMMERGAU
"Gerberei BAUER"
Prof. MESSERSCHMIDT
Director BIEFANG
fnu SPOROWSKI
Prof. Peter WAGNER
Ernst VOGT
"Bayerische Motoren Werke"
Sir FATTEN, British War Ministry
BRUCHMUEHL
"Artistic Aeronautic"

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